

## **COMMON TERMS USED IN KEEPING GOATS**

**A nanny goat (doe):** This is an adult female goat

**A Billy goat (buck):** This is an adult male goat

**Wether:** This is a castrated billy goat

**Kid:** This is a young goat

**Kidding:** This is the act of giving birth to kids (act of giving birth in goats)

**Browsing:** This is the act of feeding on leaves and soft shoots of plants

**Weaning:** This is the gradual introduction of other foods to a baby to supplement breast

milk

**Gestation period:** This is the time taken from conception to birth

**Lactation:** This is production of milk by the mother's mammary glands after birth

## **REASONS FOR GOAT KEEPING (WHY FARMERS KEEP GOATS AND SHEEP?)**

- For milk production
- For meat production
- For income after sale
- For mohair production

## **IMPORTANCE (USES) OF GOATS TO PEOPLE**

- They provide milk
- They provide meat
- They are sold for money

- Angora goats provide mohair
- They are used as dowry
- They are used as sacrifices
- Their droppings and urine are used as farm yard manure
- Their skins are used to make leather products and dance costumes

### **Examples of leather (products made from animal skins)**

- Leather shoes
- Leather bags
- Leather belts
- Leather jackets

### **TYPES OF GOATS**

A type of goats is a group of goats kept for a specific purpose

### **TYPES OF GOATS**

- Dairy breeds (milk goats)
- Meat goats
- Mohair goats

### **BREEDS OF GOATS**

A breed of goats is a group (family) of goats with the similar characteristics (features)

### **Types of breeds of goats**

## **Local breeds (indigenous/native breeds)**

- Exotic breeds
- Cross breeds

## **LOCAL BREEDS**

These are breeds of goats that have been in Uganda for a long time

Local breeds of goats are mainly kept for meat

## **Characteristics of local breeds of goats**

- They are small in size
- They are resistant to diseases
- They are resistant to bad weather
- They mature slowly
- They need less care and attention
- They have good quality products
- They produce less products

## **EXAMPLES OF LOCAL BREEDS OF GOATS**

- Mubende goats
- Small East African
- Kigezi goats
- Sebei goats
- Karamoja goats

## **ADVANTAGES OF LOCAL BREEDS**

- They are resistant to diseases
- They are resistant to bad weather
- They need less care and attention
- They produce less milk and meat
- They have good quality products

### **DISADVANTAGES OF LOCAL BREEDS**

- They mature slowly
- They produce less milk and meat
- They have hard meat

### **EXOTIC BREEDS OF GOATS**

These are breeds of goats that were imported from other countries

### **CHARACTERISTICS OF EXOTIC BREEDS OF GOATS**

- They are big in size
- They are vulnerable to diseases
- They are vulnerable to bad weather
- They need much care and attention
- They mature quickly
- They produce a lot of meat and milk

### **EXAMPLES OF EXOTIC BREEDS OF GOAT REASON FOR KEEPING THEM**

#### **For meat production**

- Boer goats

- Savanna goats
- Kalahari Red goats
- Somali goats (Galla goats)
- Galla goats (Somali goats)
- Kiko goats

### **For milk production**

- Saanen goats
- Toggenburg goats
- Alpine goats
- Anglo-Nubian goats
- Golden Guernsey goats

### **For mohair production**

Angora goats

### **Advantages of exotic breeds of goats**

- They mature quickly
- They produce a lot of meat and milk
- They have soft meat

### **Disadvantages of exotic breeds of goats**

- They are not resistant to diseases
- They are not resistant to bad weather
- They need much care and attention

## **BREEDING IN GOATS**

A Nanny goat is mated for the first time at the age of 14 – 18 months.

### How often do goats breed in a year?

Goats breed once in a year.

### **GESTATION PERIOD OF A GOAT**

Gestation period is the time taken from conception to birth

The gestation period of a nanny goat is 5 months (150 days)

### **HEAT PERIOD IN GOATS**

This is the time when the nanny goat is ready to mate with a billy goat

### **Signs of a nanny goat on heat**

- It becomes restless
- It mounts other goats
- It stands still when mounted
- It urinates frequently
- It makes a lot of noise
- Loss of appetite
- The vulva swells and turns red
- Mucus discharge from the vulva

### **CARING FOR A PREGNANT GOAT**

- Providing concentrates one month before kidding.
- ü Concentrate feeds are rich in carbohydrates and proteins.
- Providing them with mineral licks.
- ü Mineral licks are rich in mineral salts

- Providing a separate clean dry shelter to pregnant goats

## **WEANING IN GOATS**

Weaning should be done at least 3 - 4 months after kidding.

## **SIGNS OF A GOOD MILK BREED OF GOAT**

- It has a large udder and teats.
- It has large milk veins which appear below the belly.
- It has strong and well placed hind legs.
- It has strong back muscles.

## **MANAGEMENT (ROUTINE) PRACTICES IN GOAT KEEPING**

### **(Ways of caring for farm animals)**

- Numbering
- Dehorning/Disbudding
- Hoof trimming
- Castration
- Deworming
- Dehorning
- Spraying
- Dipping
- Dusting
- Culling
- Feeding
- Housing

## **NUMBERING (IDENTIFICATION OF ANIMALS)**

This is the putting of a mark or label on the body of animals.

### **Importance of numbering (livestock identification)**

- It helps a farmer to easily find his lost animals
- It helps a farmer to keep proper farm records

## **HOOF TRIMMING**

This is cutting of overgrown hooves from the animal

It reduces the risk of foot rot disease

## **DEHORNING/DISBUDDING**

Dehorning is the removal of horn buds from the animal

*Disbudding is the removal of horn buds from the animal*

It increases space in the barn/byre

## **CASTRATION**

This is the removal or inactivation of testicles of a male animal

### **METHODS OF CASTRATION**

- Open castration
- Closed castration
- Loop castration (band castration)

#### **1. OPEN CASTRATION (SURGICAL CASTRATION)**

This is when the scrotum is cut to remove the testicles

#### **Instruments used in open castration**

- Sharp knife

- Razorblade
- Scalpel

## **2. CLOSED CASTRATION**

This is the use of burdizzo to crush the sperm ducts and blood vessels

### **Instrument used in closed castration**

Burdizzo

A diagram showing a burdizzo

How is a burdizzo useful on cattle farm?

It is used in closed castration

How is a burdizzo adapted to its function?

It has blunt pincers

## **3. LOOP CASTRATION (BAND CASTRATION)**

This is the use of a rubber band to squeeze and break the sperm ducts and blood vessel

### **Instruments used in loop castration**

- Rubber band
- Elastrator

An elastrator is used to apply rubber band around the scrotum during band castration

**Why is loop castration impossible in pigs (boars)?**

They don't have sagging testicles

### **ADVANTAGES OF CASTRATION**

- It prevents inbreeding
- It prevents random mating
- It makes the animal humble (docile)
- It makes the animal grow big and fat
- It reduces bad smell in male animals
- It prevents unwanted pregnancies

### **DISADVANTAGES OF CASTRATION**

- It is painful
- It increases the risk of infections
- It needs a skilled person
- It denies the male animal its right of reproduction

### **DEWORMING**

This is the giving of medicine through the mouth to kill worms (endoparasites) in animals

Why farmers deworm their animals? (Importance of deworming)

To kill endoparasites (worms)

### **METHODS OF DEWORMING**

- Drenching

- Dosing

## **1. DOSING**

This is the giving of solid medicine through the mouth to kill worms in animals

## **2. DRENCHING**

This is the giving of liquid medicine through the mouth to kill worms in animals.

### **Farm tools used for drenching**

- Drenching gun
- Syringe
- Bottle

How is a drenching gun important on a livestock farm?

It is used for drenching

State the importance of spraying, dipping and dusting livestock with acaricides

- To kill ticks and mites
- To prevent tick-borne diseases

How is a knapsack sprayer important on a goat farm?

It is used for spraying acaricides

## **HOUSING GOATS**

This is the act of constructing a house for goats

### **QUALITIES OF A GOOD HOUSE FOR GOATS**

- It should be well ventilated

- It should have a strong roof
- It should have a slanting floor
- It should be clean and dry

### **IMPORTANCE OF A HOUSE TO GOATS**

- To protect goats from bad weather
- To protect goats from predators
- To protect goats from thieves

### **DANGERS OF SHARING A HOUSE WITH DOMESTIC ANIMALS**

- It leads to bad smell in the house
- It leads to parasites in the house
- It leads to competition for oxygen
- It leads to easy spread of diseases to people
- It leads to destruction of household property

### **SYSTEMS (METHODS) OF GRAZING GOATS**

- Free range grazing or Herding
- Tethering
- Paddock grazing
- Zero grazing
- Strip grazing

### **Mention three methods of rotational grazing**

- Tethering
- Paddock grazing

- Strip grazing

## **HERDING**

This is when a herdsman looks after animals as they graze

It is also called free range grazing because animals move on their own looking for food

### **Advantages of herding**

- Animals get a balanced diet
- Animals make enough body exercise
- Less attention is needed
- It is cheap to manage

### **Disadvantages of herding**

- It leads to easy spread of diseases
- Animals can destroy crops
- Animals can get lost
- It needs a big piece of land
- It can lead to overgrazing

## **Paddock Grazing**

This is the method of grazing in which a pastureland divided into small fenced plots

Paddocks are small fenced plots on pastureland

### **Advantages of paddock grazing**

- It allows proper use of pasture

- It gives pasture time to grow
- It controls over grazing
- It controls tickborne diseases
- Manure is evenly distributed on the farm

*How does paddock grazing control ectoparasites and diseases in livestock?*

It starves ticks to death (it breaks the feeding cycle of ticks)

### **DISADVANTAGES OF Paddock GRAZING**

- It is expensive to manage
- It needs a big piece of land
- Animals do not make enough body exercises

### **STRIP GRAZING**

This is the grazing of animals on a pastureland divided into strips using electric wires.

#### **Advantages of strip grazing**

- There is proper use of pasture.
- It controls diseases and parasites
- It prevents over grazing
- Animals do not destroy crops

#### **Disadvantages of strip grazing**

- It is expensive to maintain
- Few animals are kept
- Animals do not make enough body exercises

- It can only be used in areas with electricity

## **TETHERING**

This is the method of grazing where a farmer ties the animal on a peg or tree using a rope

The animals tethered is moved to a new place when necessarys

### **Advantages of tethering**

- There is no need for fencing
- It is easy to start
- It is cheap to manage
- It needs a small piece of land
- Animals may not destroy crops
- The farmer gets time to do other work

### **Disadvantages of tethering**

- Animals do not get balanced diet
- Few animals are kept
- Animals can easily be stolen
- Animals can easily be killed by predators
- The rope can easily strangle the animal
- Animals do not make enough body exercises

## **ZERO GRAZING**

This is the keeping of animals in stalls where water and food are provided.

It is also be called **stall grazing**

An illustration showing zero grazing

### **Advantages of zero grazing**

Many animals are kept in a small area

- It prevents wastage of feeds
- It needs a small piece of land
- It protects animals from bad weather
- It is easy to collect manure
- It is easy to cull sick animals
- Animals produce a lot of milk

Why? There is no wastage of energy

- It controls the spread of diseases and parasites

### **Disadvantages of zero grazing**

- It is expensive to manage
- Animals lack body exercises
- It needs a lot of labour